Syllabus

STAT 251 Statistical Methods Section 01

- **Instructor:** Jarred M. Kvamme (pronounced “Kuh-Wah-mee”), PhD, Research Computing and Data Services. **Email** jarredk@uidaho.edu. My office is **Brink Hall, Room B11A**. My office hours are 2:00PM - 5:00PM on Mondays, or by appointment.
- **Teaching Assistant:** Kyla LaFountain. **Email:** klafountain@uidaho.edu. Office: **Brink Hall, Room B6/7**. Office hours: 10:00AM - 12:00PM on Mondays.
- **Meeting Time:** This course is scheduled to meet from 12:30PM-1:20PM MWF in **TLC 040**.
- **Learning Outcomes:** Introduction to statistical methods including statistical description, data displays, design of statistical studies, basic sampling methods, descriptive statistics, probability and sampling distributions; interval and point estimation, statistical inference in surveys and experiments, simple linear regression, and analysis of variance.
- **Prerequisites:** One of the following: Math 143 (with a ‘C’ or better), Math 160, Math 170, or sufficient score on SAT, ACT, or math placement test see the math placement requirements (https://www.uidaho.edu/registrar/registration/placement)
- **Course Materials:**
    - **Textbook:** Barbara Illowsky, Susan Dean, et. al. (2017). Introductory Statistics. OpenStax. Licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License (CC BY 4.0). OpenStax.org. (https://openstax.org/details/books/introductory-statistics-2e) You can either use the PDF version or buy a hard copy from various sites, including OpenStax.org, Amazon.com, etc.
    - **Calculator:** You will need any type of calculator that has the exponent and square-root function for homework and tests.
    - **Laptop:** A laptop is **required for examinations**. Examinations are proctored in class but delivered through **Canvas**, so you must bring a **fully charged laptop** to class on exam days.
    - **Course Website:** Course materials including lecture notes, homework assignments, study guides, this syllabus, and other materials can be found on the course website (https://jarred6068.github.io/Kvamme_UI_STAT251/index.html)

- **Attendance:** Class attendance is required and is worth **5%** of your course grade. Excluding holidays, examination and review days, and dead week, there are 35 days of class. You are permitted to miss up to four days of class with no penalty, so your attendance will be computed as the proportion of days attending out of a total of 31 days. Beyond those four days you may only be excused for appropriate documented university sanctioned events or extreme circumstances (such as sudden illness). If you cannot attend your courses for an extended time due to a health-related issue or family emergency (e.g., COVID or death in the family), you should file a VandalCare (https://www.uidaho.edu/student-affairs/dean-of-students/vandalcare) Report or contact the The Dean of Students (https://www.uidaho.edu/student-affairs/dean-of-students) so that the university can document your absence and contact your instructors. You should plan to reserve your four "free" days of non-attendance for other short-term absences due to illness or other reasons. You may not be counted as being in attendance if you are not engaged in class (e.g., sleeping, using your phone/computer), arrive to class late, or leave class early. Attendance will be recorded daily via a one-question quiz in Canvas (https://canvas.uidaho.edu/courses/25778).
- **Communication Expectations:** Communication is key. If you are experiencing challenges that impact your attendance, please reach out early. We want to help you stay engaged and successful. You are accountable for timely communication of any challenges that may impact your attendance. If you anticipate being absent from class, please email to let me know.
- **Assessment:**
    - **Homework:** Homework assignments will be made available on the course website under the *Homeworks* tab. There will be **5 homework assignments**, worth **15%** of your course grade altogether (**3%** per assignment). Homework will be submitted in **Canvas** by **11:59PM on the due dates** (Sundays), which are listed on the course website under the *Course Schedule* (Course_Schedule.html) tab and in Canvas. Assignments must be completed in pen or pencil on paper (any type of paper is fine); scan or photograph your work and upload it to Canvas. Homework is graded as completed or not completed: a complete assignment receives full points, while a partial or late assignment receives half credit. Homework will not be handed back; after each assignment is submitted, the answer key will be posted on the course website. Some exam problems are based on homework problems (although the numbers may be changed) so it is highly recommended that you complete all homework assignments in advance of each examination.

- **Course Project:** In addition to homework, a course project will be assigned which is a designed to integrate and apply knowledge gained throughout the semester. The course project is worth **20%** of your course grade. Details for the course project are posted under the **Course Project** tab in the course website (https://jarred6068.github.io/Kvamme_UI_STAT251/index.html). The project will be due in **Canvas** on **12/19 at 11:59PM**. A short project check (a description of your dataset and the statistical question you plan to investigate; see the **Course Project** tab) is due in **Canvas** on **10/18 at 11:59PM**.
- **Exams:** There will be 3 midterm examinations, worth **40%** of your course grade altogether (about **13.33%** per examination). Each examination is worth **50 points**. The tentative dates of these exams are **9/18, 10/16, 11/20**. Students will have the entire 50 minute class period to complete their exam. Examinations are **proctored in class but delivered through Canvas**, so you must bring a **fully charged laptop** on examination days. **Notes are not permitted on the midterm examinations.** Calculators are permitted (and sometimes necessary), but must not be capable of wireless communication. Calculators used during the examination may not be shared. Students are expected to bring their own calculators and laptops on examination days. Study guides for examinations will be made available on the course website in the *study guides section* typically two lecture days before the examination. Make-ups for missed examinations will only be permitted for documented university sanctioned events or in extreme circumstances. Notice of a missed examination due to a foreseeable absence must be given at least one week before the scheduled day of the examination. Notice of a missed examination due to unforeseeable absence must be made before the end of the day for which the examination was scheduled. If I contact you to schedule a make-up you must respond promptly (i.e., the same day) or you may not be able to make it up.
- **Final Exam:** The final examination is worth **20%** of your course grade. It is held during finals week on **Monday, December 14, 2026 from 12:45PM–2:45PM** in **TLC 040**. The final examination may not be taken at another time unless, as according to university policy, you have more than two final examinations on that day, or a conflict with a documented university sanctioned event. The amount of time permitted to complete the final examination is two hours (120 minutes). The final examination is like that of the other examinations except that it is comprehensive and longer. A study guide for the final examination will be made available. Policies regarding the first three examinations also apply to the final examination, except that you are permitted to use up to **five pages** of notes for the final examination (8.5 by 11 inches maximum, writing on both sides is fine).

- **Grading:** Your course grade is computed from the following weights: attendance (5%), homework (15% altogether; 3% per assignment), the course project (20%), the three midterm examinations (40% altogether; about 13.33% per examination), and the final examination (20%). Letter grades for the course will be assigned according to the following rubric: A ($87.5\% - 100\%$), B ($75\% - 87.5\%$), C ($62.5\% - 75\%$), D ($50\% - 62.5\%$), F (less than 50%). Course grades are based solely on the examination scores, attendance, collected homeworks, the course project, and the grading rubric described above. Changes to the grading system (e.g., the grade rubric or the weights) will not result in any students getting a lower letter grade than that obtained using the system described above. Grades will be updated periodically in Canvas (https://canvas.uidaho.edu/courses/25778) so that you may track your progress in the course.

- **Drop-in Tutoring:** The Statistics Assistance Center (SAC) is a free drop-in tutoring service located in the library See link here (https://www.uidaho.edu/sci/mathstat/centers/sac) for more information. Tutoring is also available through Academic Support Programs see link here (https://www.uidaho.edu/current-students/academic-support/asp/tcs/tutoring).

- **Academic Honesty:** You are responsible for being aware of the policies of the University of Idaho on academic honesty. See Section A-1 of Article II of the Student Code of Conduct (https://www.uidaho.edu/student-affairs/dean-of-students/student-conduct/students). This includes but is not limited to cheating, facilitation of cheating, and furnishing false information or false representation. **Breaches of academic honesty will not be tolerated, and will result in a F for the course and referral to the Dean of Students for further disciplinary action**

- **Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI):** My view is that AI is a tool, and like any tool it should be used responsibly. Used well, it can make you a better student. Asking an AI to act as an editor for your writing, to help you search for and find resources, to explain a concept you are stuck on in a different way, or to help you map out and organize a project are all reasonable uses that support your learning. Those uses are welcome in this course.

  Used poorly, AI replaces your learning instead of supporting it. Asking an AI to write your project for you and handing in work you took no real part in producing is not your work. It does not help you learn the material, it is academically dishonest, and it falls under the **Academic Honesty** policy above. I will be able to tell when an assignment was completed by an AI rather than by you. **All course projects will be scanned for original work. Students who do not disclose the use of AI on their work and whose work is found to contain AI generated material will be considered to have violated academic integrity under the University of Idaho Student Code of Conduct (https://www.uidaho.edu/policies/fsh/2/2300#e1), and it may affect their grade.**

If you use AI in any capacity on your course project, you are required to disclose it. Along with your project you must submit (1) the prompts you gave the AI, (2) a citation for any AI-generated material you included, using an appropriate citation format (MLA, APA, etc.), and (3) a brief description explaining how you used AI and which service provider you used (e.g., OpenAI, Anthropic, Google). This practice helps you reflect on your learning process and ensures transparency in your academic work. If you are unsure how to document or cite AI use, please reach out or visit the University of Idaho Writing Center (https://www.uidaho.edu/student-resources/academic-support/writing-center) for support.

We live in a technological age, and learning how to augment your work and your learning with AI is a skill that will be expected of you both as a student and as a professional. This course is a good place to start building that skill. Use these tools to strengthen your own thinking, not to replace it.

- **Disability Access:** Reasonable accommodations are available for students who have documented temporary or permanent disabilities. All accommodations must be approved through the Center for Disability Access and Resources (CDAR) located in the Bruce M. Pitman Center, Suite 127 in order to notify your instructor(s) as soon as possible regarding accommodation(s) needed for the course. Contact CDAR at 208-885-6307 or cdar@uidaho.edu. For more information, see the CDAR website (https://www.uidaho.edu/current-students/cdar).
- **Title IX:** University of Idaho is committed to creating a safe learning environment for all students. Consistent with this, UI policy and Title IX prohibit sexual misconduct, which includes sex or gender based harassment, sexual assault, intimate partner violence, stalking, and retaliation. If you have experienced any form of sexual misconduct, know that help and support are available. Please be aware that all University of Idaho employees are mandatory reporters and are required to report any information they receive about sexual misconduct to the university's Title IX Coordinator within 24 hours (Idaho State Board Policy, Section I, I.T.). see link (https://www.uidaho.edu/ocri/title-nine/resources) to learn more about which resources on campus and within our community are confidential. If you would like to report an incident, you may do so anonymously by visiting www.uidaho.edu/vandalcare (https://www.uidaho.edu/student-affairs/dean-of-students/vandalcare?utm_campaign=vandal-care-reports&utm_content=bias-committee&utm_medium=varied&utm_source=sa-vandalcare) or you can directly contact the Office of Civil Rights and Investigations at **208-885-4285** or ocri@uidaho.edu.
- **UI Moscow Land Acknowledgement:** The University of Idaho welcomes and respects all people. UI Moscow is located on the homelands of the Nimiipuu (Nez Perce), Palus (Palouse), and Schitsu'umsh (Coeur d'Alene) tribes. We extend gratitude to the indigenous people that call this place home, since time immemorial.